MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

OFFICIAL OFQUAL SPECIFICATION

LEVEL 1 & E3

CORE REVISION GUIDE • MODEL ANSWERS

DIGITAL

DIGITAL SKILLS

PRACTICAL HANDBOOK

EDSQ Complete Standards & Workplace Skills

Using Devices | Creating Media | Communicating | Online Safety

PEARSON EDEXCEL & CITY & GUILDS ALIGNED

2026/2027 EDITION

DIGITAL SKILLS

Essential Digital Skills • EDSQ

Comprehensive National Standards Handbook • The 5 Statutory Domains, Software Workflows & Practical Mock Exams

This book belongs to:	Exam date:	Target level:

What is inside

1	Digital Hardware, Cloud Storage & Operating System Architecture	p. 3
2	National Curriculum Diagnostic Skills Audit & Baseline Assessment	p. 4
3	The 5 Statutory Skill Areas Overview & Examination Structure	p. 5
4	Learner Progress Tracker & Digital Portfolio Roadmap	p. 6
U1–U10	10 Comprehensive Practical Units Across All 5 Domains (40 pages)	p. 7
M1–M4	4 Complete Official-Style Workplace Scenario Mocks (16 pages)	p. 47
LAB1–LAB6	6 Advanced Digital Software Labs • Workplace Architecture (12 pages)	p. 63
REF	Comprehensive Solutions, Shortcuts, Glossary & Index (10 pages)	p. 75
CERT	Digital Skills Competency Passport & Official Certificate (4 pages)	p. 85

How to use this book

Read
Read the rule. Study the picture.

Try
Write your answers on the lines.

Check
Mark it with the answers at the back.

Remember
Learn the Golden Rule by heart.

EDSQ FOUNDATION KNOWLEDGE

HW Hardware, OS & Cloud Architecture



Modern workplace productivity relies on seamless cloud integration.

Essential Computing Infrastructure

Operating Systems (Windows/macOS/ChromeOS): File hierarchy, file extensions (.docx, .xlsx, .pdf, .zip), and accessibility tools.

Input/Output Peripherals: Bluetooth keyboards, webcams, multi-monitor displays, and network printers.

Cloud Synchronization: Storing files on OneDrive, Google Drive, or Nextcloud for automated backup and collaborative multi-user editing.

Network Protocols: Wi-Fi security (WPA3), VPN encrypted tunnels, and mobile data hotspotting.

Security Golden Rule

Always check the file extension before opening attachments (.exe or .scr often signify malware).

Workplace Trap!

Remember to lock your workstation (Win + L) whenever stepping away from your desk.

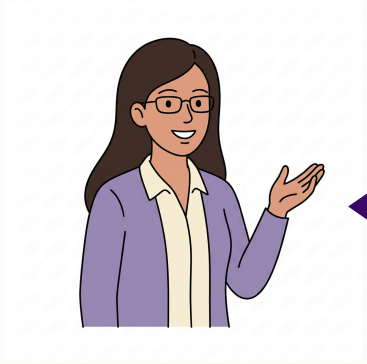
✎ Personal Hardware & System Configuration Notes

SELF-ASSESSMENT & SKILLS AUDIT

AU National Curriculum Baseline Audit

DfE Essential Digital Skills Diagnostic Matrix

Skill Area	Core National Standard Competency	Rating
1. Devices & Handling Info	Manage files, folders, cloud storage, and configure accessibility settings.	[ ] / 5
2. Creating & Editing	Draft formal documents, build spreadsheets with formulas, format charts.	[ ] / 5
3. Communicating	Send professional emails with attachments, participate in video conferences.	[ ] / 5
4. Transacting	Complete online forms, verify secure checkout (SSL padlocks), manage online billing.	[ ] / 5
5. Being Safe & Responsible	Identify phishing, manage passwords (2FA), protect digital footprint, understand GDPR.	[ ] / 5



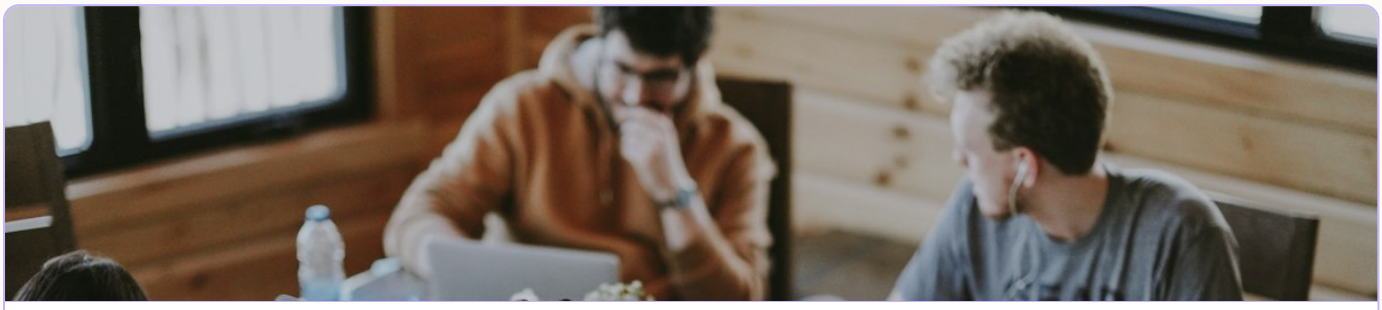
Priya

Evaluate yourself honestly! Any skill rated below 3 will receive focused remediation in our software laboratory sections.

✎ Priority Digital Skills to Upgrade in this Course

PEARSON EDEXCEL EDSQ ASSESSMENT STRUCTURE

National Standards & Examination Blueprint



Digital Functional Skills qualifications prepare learners for modern office roles.

EDSQ Assessment Specifications

Component 1 • Knowledge Test (20%): Multiple-choice and drag-and-drop questions testing cybersecurity, online safety, GDPR, and device troubleshooting.

Component 2 • Practical Tasks (80%): Hands-on computer-based workplace scenarios involving spreadsheet calculations, email correspondence, and folder structure.

Pass Mark Benchmark: Typically 65–70% across practical scenario tasks.

Software Suite: Microsoft Office 365, Google Workspace, or standard web browsers.

Crucial Exam Protocol: Saving Your Work

Examiners cannot grade work that is not saved! Always save your files to the designated candidate exam folder with the correct filename convention (e.g. `CandidateName_Task1_Budget.xlsx`) every 5 minutes.

✎ My Practical Exam Software & Shortcut Strategy

TR

UNIT & MOCK MASTERY LOG

Digital Skills Progress Tracker

Learner Competency Milestone Tracker

Unit / Mock Paper	Domain	Practical Score	Knowledge Check	Date
Unit 1: Operating Systems, File Hier...	Domain 1: Us	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 2: Advanced Search Syntax & Inf...	Domain 1: Us	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 3: Professional Word Processing...	Domain 2: Cr	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 4: Spreadsheet Architecture, Fo...	Domain 2: Cr	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 5: Presentation Design, Multime...	Domain 2: Cr	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 6: Professional Email Etiquette...	Domain 3: Co	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 7: Video Conferencing, Collabor...	Domain 3: Co	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 8: E-Commerce, Online Invoicing...	Domain 4: Tr	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 9: Digital Public Services & Of...	Domain 4: Tr	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 10: Cybersecurity Hygiene, Phish...	Domain 5: Be	/10	[ ] Pass	
Mock Exam 1: Scenario Simulation	Synoptic	/50	[ ] Pass	
Mock Exam 2: Scenario Simulation	Synoptic	/50	[ ] Pass	
Mock Exam 3: Scenario Simulation	Synoptic	/50	[ ] Pass	
Mock Exam 4: Scenario Simulation	Synoptic	/50	[ ] Pass	

✎ Tutor Coaching Feedback & IT Target Settings

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 1: USING DEVICES & HANDLING INFORMATION

D1.1

Unit 1 • Operating Systems, File Hierarchy & Cloud Storage



Workplace Application: Operating Systems, File Hierarchy & Cloud Storage

Core Knowledge & Statutory Standards

Operating Systems & File Systems: Modern workplace devices operate on Windows, macOS, ChromeOS, or mobile OS (iOS/Android). A structured hierarchical file architecture organises data into logical nested folders (e.g. `/Documents/Clients/2025/Invoices/`). Standard file naming conventions use ISO dates and clear descriptors (e.g. `2025-05-14_Invoice_SmithLtd_v2.pdf`) to avoid version confusion.

Cloud Storage & Synchronisation: Cloud platforms (OneDrive, Google Drive, Nextcloud) synchronize local files to secure remote servers. This enables multi-device access, automated version history, and real-time multi-author collaboration with granular viewing/editing permissions.

Workplace Context & Employer Expectations

In modern enterprises, competence in **Operating Systems, File Hierarchy & Cloud Storage** is essential for data security, administrative velocity, and regulatory compliance.

✎ Personal Concept Notes & Statutory Vocabulary

D1.1

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • OPERATING SYSTEMS, FILE HIERARCHY & CLOUD STORAGE

Unit 1 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Step 1:	Create a root project folder with the standardized format: `YYYY-MM_ProjectName`.
Step 2:	Establish logical subfolders: `01_Briefs`, `02_Working_Drafts`, `03_Assets`, `04_Final_Approved`.
Step 3:	Apply read-only permissions to final distribution PDFs and full edit access to designated team members.
Step 4:	Verify cloud synchronization status icons (green checkmark = synced locally, cloud icon = online only).

Productivity Tip

Create a desktop shortcut for folders used on a daily basis to eliminate navigation latency.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Saving multiple files named 'Draft1.docx', 'Draft_final.docx', 'Draft_real_final.docx' loses marks. Always use ISO dates and version numbers (v1.0, v1.1)!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D1.1

APPLIED SCENARIO PRACTICE • SOFTWARE LAB

Unit 1 • Hands-On Practical Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 1

Scenario: You are organizing the digital assets for a regional charity campaign. Outline a nested 3-tier folder structure, specify standard naming for 3 distinct files, and explain why saving directly to the Desktop causes governance risks.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Software Command Steps

Practical Drill Verification

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification:

_____

D1.1

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 1 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Security & Workflow Traps to Avoid

Trap: Examiner Trap: Saving multiple files named 'Draft1.docx', 'Draft_final.docx', 'Draft_real_final.docx' loses marks. Always use ISO dates and version numbers (v1.0, v1.1)!
Prevention: Always audit inputs, lock credentials with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient address fields before clicking send.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Which file format preserves document formatting identically across all operating systems?

[ ] A) .txt [ ] B) .pdf [ ] C) .csv [ ] D) .rtf

2. What is the correct formula to calculate the average of cells B2 to B20?

[ ] A) =MEAN(B2:B20) [ ] B) =AVERAGE(B2:B20) [ ] C) =AVG(B2-B20)

3. Under GDPR, within how many hours must a serious personal data breach be reported?

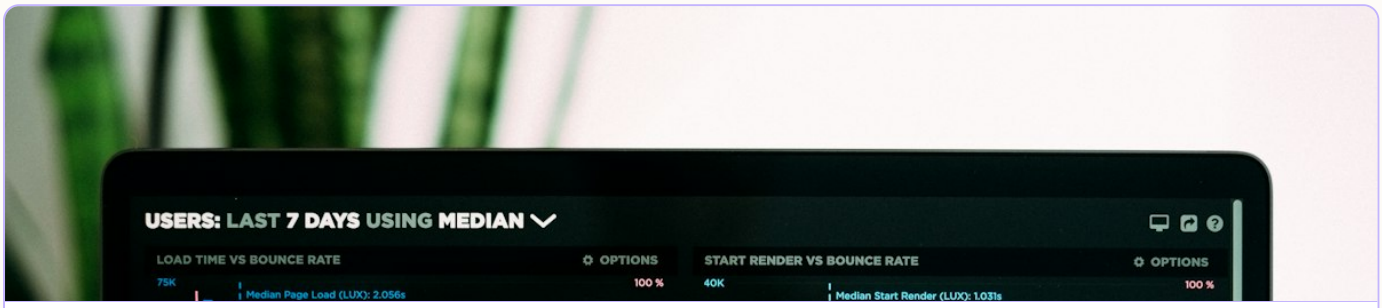
[ ] A) 24 hours [ ] B) 48 hours [ ] C) 72 hours [ ] D) 7 days

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 1: USING DEVICES & HANDLING INFORMATION

D1.2

Unit 2 • Advanced Search Syntax & Information Verification



Workplace Application: Advanced Search Syntax & Information Verification

Core Knowledge & Statutory Standards

Search Syntax & Precision Filtering: Professional workplace research requires targeted Boolean operators and search filters: quotes `"exact phrase"` for verbatim matching, `site:.gov.uk` to restrict results to verified government domains, `filetype:pdf` for official reports, and the minus operator `-keyword` to exclude irrelevant commercial results.

CRAAP Evaluation Framework: Not all online data is reliable. Candidates must evaluate information using the CRAAP test: **C**urrency (publication date), **R**elevance (matches research scope), **A**uthority (author credentials and domain reputation), **A**ccuracy (backed by cited evidence), and **P**urpose (identifying commercial bias vs objective research).

Workplace Context & Employer Expectations

In modern enterprises, competence in **Advanced Search Syntax & Information Verification** is essential for data security, administrative velocity, and regulatory compliance.

✎ Personal Concept Notes & Statutory Vocabulary

D1.2

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • ADVANCED SEARCH SYNTAX & INFORMATION VERIFICATION

Unit 2 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Step 1:	Construct a targeted Boolean query: e.g. `"apprenticeship minimum wage" site:.gov.uk filetype:pdf`.
Step 2:	Inspect the top 3 results for author credentials, publication date, and cited research references.
Step 3:	Cross-reference key numerical claims against at least two independent primary statistical sources.
Step 4:	Record the full URL, retrieval date, and author name for transparent professional citation.

Productivity Tip

Create a desktop shortcut for folders used on a daily basis to eliminate navigation latency.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Citing sponsored blog posts or commercial sales pages (.com) as official legislation evidence. Always cross-check against official (.gov.uk or .org.uk) repositories!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D1.2

APPLIED SCENARIO PRACTICE • SOFTWARE LAB

Unit 2 • Hands-On Practical Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 2

Scenario: Your manager asks you to verify whether a viral social media post claiming a new statutory UK minimum wage rate is accurate. Formulate two search queries, identify the primary authority domain to check, and explain how to spot misinformation.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Software Command Steps

Practical Drill Verification

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification:

_____

D1.2

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 2 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Security & Workflow Traps to Avoid

Trap: Examiner Trap: Citing sponsored blog posts or commercial sales pages (.com) as official legislation evidence. Always cross-check against official (.gov.uk or .org.uk) repositories!
Prevention: Always audit inputs, lock credentials with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient address fields before clicking send.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Which file format preserves document formatting identically across all operating systems?

[ ] A) .txt [ ] B) .pdf [ ] C) .csv [ ] D) .rtf

2. What is the correct formula to calculate the average of cells B2 to B20?

[ ] A) =MEAN(B2:B20) [ ] B) =AVERAGE(B2:B20) [ ] C) =AVG(B2-B20)

3. Under GDPR, within how many hours must a serious personal data breach be reported?

[ ] A) 24 hours [ ] B) 48 hours [ ] C) 72 hours [ ] D) 7 days

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 2: CREATING & EDITING

D2.1

Unit 3 • Professional Word Processing & Structured Documents



Workplace Application: Professional Word Processing & Structured Documents

▶ Core Knowledge & Statutory Standards

Document Hierarchy & Styles: Professional word processing (MS Word, Google Docs) relies on semantic paragraph styles (`Heading 1`, `Heading 2`, `Body Text`) rather than manual font resizing. Styles guarantee consistent typography, automatically generate clickable Tables of Contents, and maintain screen reader accessibility.

Tables, Headers & Page Architecture: Long documents require structured headers and footers with automated page numbering (`Page X of Y`), balanced margins (minimum 20 mm), accessible data tables with dedicated header rows, and embedded high-resolution graphics with descriptive Alt-Text.

★ Workplace Context & Employer Expectations

In modern enterprises, competence in **Professional Word Processing & Structured Documents** is essential for data security, administrative velocity, and regulatory compliance.

✎ Personal Concept Notes & Statutory Vocabulary

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • PROFESSIONAL WORD PROCESSING & STRUCTURED DOCUMENTS

D2.1

Unit 3 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Step 1:	Apply Heading 1 to primary chapters and Heading 2 to sub-sections to establish a logical outline.
Step 2:	Insert an automated Table of Contents linked directly to heading styles.
Step 3:	Format data into an accessible table: specify a repeating header row and zebra-stripe alternating shading for readability.
Step 4:	Add descriptive alternative text (Alt-Text) to all photographic images to comply with WCAG accessibility standards.

Productivity Tip

Create a desktop shortcut for folders used on a daily basis to eliminate navigation latency.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Hitting 'Enter' repeatedly to force text onto a new page. Always use a proper Page Break (Ctrl+Enter) or Section Break!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D2.1

APPLIED SCENARIO PRACTICE • SOFTWARE LAB

Unit 3 • Hands-On Practical Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 3

Scenario: Format a 4-page health and safety executive briefing document. Specify font hierarchy (title, headings, body), explain the benefit of using Styles instead of manual bolding, and describe how to make a 5-column incident log table fully accessible.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Software Command Steps

Practical Drill Verification

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification:

_____

D2.1

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 3 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Security & Workflow Traps to Avoid

Trap: Examiner Trap: Hitting 'Enter' repeatedly to force text onto a new page. Always use a proper Page Break (Ctrl+Enter) or Section Break!
Prevention: Always audit inputs, lock credentials with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient address fields before clicking send.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Which file format preserves document formatting identically across all operating systems?

[ ] A) .txt [ ] B) .pdf [ ] C) .csv [ ] D) .rtf

2. What is the correct formula to calculate the average of cells B2 to B20?

[ ] A) =MEAN(B2:B20) [ ] B) =AVERAGE(B2:B20) [ ] C) =AVG(B2-B20)

3. Under GDPR, within how many hours must a serious personal data breach be reported?

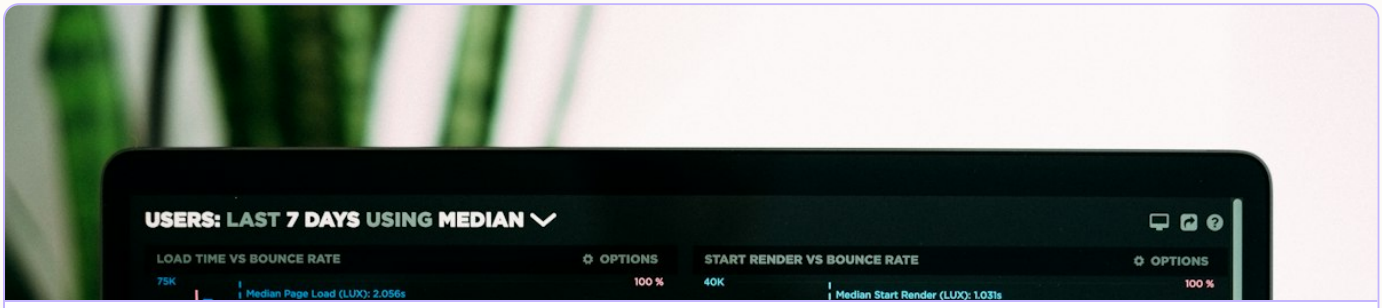
[ ] A) 24 hours [ ] B) 48 hours [ ] C) 72 hours [ ] D) 7 days

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 2: CREATING & EDITING

D2.2

Unit 4 • Spreadsheet Architecture, Formulas & Data Visualisation



Workplace Application: Spreadsheet Architecture, Formulas & Data Visualisation

▶ Core Knowledge & Statutory Standards

Spreadsheet Principles: Spreadsheets (MS Excel, Google Sheets) manage numerical and tabular records across columns and rows. Formulas always begin with an equals sign (=) and use relative cell referencing (`=B2*C2`) or absolute cell referencing (`=$B$1*C2`) to automate calculations without manual data re-entry.

Essential Formulas & Functions: Statutory Level 1 & Level 2 standards require mastery of: `=SUM(range)` for totals, `=AVERAGE(range)` for arithmetic means, `=COUNT(range)` / `=COUNTA(range)`, `=MIN(range)` and `=MAX(range)`, and logical conditional expressions `=IF(logical_test, value_if_true, value_if_false)`.

★ Workplace Context & Employer Expectations

In modern enterprises, competence in **Spreadsheet Architecture, Formulas & Data Visualisation** is essential for data security, administrative velocity, and regulatory compliance.

✎ Personal Concept Notes & Statutory Vocabulary

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • SPREADSHEET ARCHITECTURE, FORMULAS & DATA VISUALISATION

D2.2

Unit 4 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Step 1:	Enter clear column headers in Row 1: Item, Unit Cost, Quantity, Line Total, Reorder Status.
Step 2:	Apply formula `=B2*C2` to calculate line total, then double-click the fill handle to auto-populate the column.
Step 3:	Calculate summary metrics in the bottom row using `=SUM(D2:D50)` and `=AVERAGE(B2:B50)`.
Step 4:	Apply an `IF` function to column E: `=IF(C2<10, 'REORDER', 'OK')`.
Step 5:	Select the data range and generate a clean Column or Bar Chart with labeled axes and a descriptive chart title.

Productivity Tip

Create a desktop shortcut for folders used on a daily basis to eliminate navigation latency.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Typing hardcoded numbers into a formula (e.g. '=B2*12.50') instead of referencing cells. Always keep variable rates in separate parameter cells!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D2.2

APPLIED SCENARIO PRACTICE • SOFTWARE LAB

Unit 4 • Hands-On Practical Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 4

Scenario: Create an inventory management sheet for 20 warehouse product lines. Show the exact formulas for Line Total, Overall Spend, Average Unit Cost, and an automated 'Low Stock' alert for any item with under 15 units remaining.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Software Command Steps

Practical Drill Verification

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification:

_____

D2.2

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 4 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Security & Workflow Traps to Avoid

Trap: Examiner Trap: Typing hardcoded numbers into a formula (e.g. '=B2*12.50') instead of referencing cells. Always keep variable rates in separate parameter cells!
Prevention: Always audit inputs, lock credentials with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient address fields before clicking send.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Which file format preserves document formatting identically across all operating systems?

[ ] A) .txt [ ] B) .pdf [ ] C) .csv [ ] D) .rtf

2. What is the correct formula to calculate the average of cells B2 to B20?

[ ] A) =MEAN(B2:B20) [ ] B) =AVERAGE(B2:B20) [ ] C) =AVG(B2-B20)

3. Under GDPR, within how many hours must a serious personal data breach be reported?

[ ] A) 24 hours [ ] B) 48 hours [ ] C) 72 hours [ ] D) 7 days

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 2: CREATING & EDITING

D2.3

Unit 5 • Presentation Design, Multimedia & Digital Accessibility



Workplace Application: Presentation Design, Multimedia & Digital Accessibility

▶ Core Knowledge & Statutory Standards

Visual Storytelling & Cognitive Load: Effective slide presentations (PowerPoint, Google Slides) communicate complex ideas succinctly. Avoid wall-of-text slides; adhere to the 6x6 guideline (maximum 6 bullet points, maximum 6 words per bullet). Use high-contrast color palettes (dark text on white/cream backgrounds) and legible sans-serif typography (Arial, Calibri, Montserrat) at 24pt+ for readability.

Multimedia Integration & Accessibility: Audio and video clips must be compressed and formatted with closed captions. Ensure all visual graphics have Alt-Text descriptions. Never use colour as the sole visual indicator of status (e.g. combine green/red icons with text labels 'Pass' / 'Fail').

★ Workplace Context & Employer Expectations

In modern enterprises, competence in **Presentation Design, Multimedia & Digital Accessibility** is essential for data security, administrative velocity, and regulatory compliance.

✎ Personal Concept Notes & Statutory Vocabulary

D2.3

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • PRESENTATION DESIGN, MULTIMEDIA & DIGITAL ACCESSIBILITY

Unit 5 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Step 1:	Select a clean, accessible presentation template with high contrast and consistent slide masters.
Step 2:	Summarise source data into 3 key bullet takeaways accompanied by a clear, high-resolution infographic.
Step 3:	Embed audio/video files and verify that automatic playback and subtitling are enabled.
Step 4:	Run the built-in Accessibility Checker to detect missing alternative text or low-contrast warnings.

Productivity Tip

Create a desktop shortcut for folders used on a daily basis to eliminate navigation latency.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Using distracting animations and transition effects that detract from readability. Keep transitions simple, subtle, and consistent!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D2.3

APPLIED SCENARIO PRACTICE • SOFTWARE LAB

Unit 5 • Hands-On Practical Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 5

Scenario: Design a 5-slide induction deck for new healthcare apprentices. Outline slide titles, bullet point content for Slide 2, and explain 3 design choices made to ensure the presentation is accessible to visually impaired learners.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Software Command Steps

Practical Drill Verification

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification:

_____

D2.3

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 5 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Security & Workflow Traps to Avoid

Trap: Examiner Trap: Using distracting animations and transition effects that detract from readability. Keep transitions simple, subtle, and consistent!
Prevention: Always audit inputs, lock credentials with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient address fields before clicking send.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Which file format preserves document formatting identically across all operating systems?

[ ] A) .txt [ ] B) .pdf [ ] C) .csv [ ] D) .rtf

2. What is the correct formula to calculate the average of cells B2 to B20?

[ ] A) =MEAN(B2:B20) [ ] B) =AVERAGE(B2:B20) [ ] C) =AVG(B2-B20)

3. Under GDPR, within how many hours must a serious personal data breach be reported?

[ ] A) 24 hours [ ] B) 48 hours [ ] C) 72 hours [ ] D) 7 days

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 3: COMMUNICATING

D3.1

Unit 6 • Professional Email Etiquette, Attachments & Scheduling



Workplace Application: Professional Email Etiquette, Attachments & Scheduling

Core Knowledge & Statutory Standards

Workplace Email Protocols: Business email requires precise communication conventions: a concise, informative subject line (e.g. `Action Required: Q3 Budget Review Meeting – 14 June`), professional salutations (`Dear Mr Davies,` / `Good morning Sarah,`), and appropriate closing sign-offs. Understand recipient fields: **To** for primary action owners, **Cc** (Carbon Copy) for informational awareness, and **Bcc** (Blind Carbon Copy) for mass distributions to preserve recipient data privacy under UK GDPR.

Calendar Scheduling & Secure Attachments: Scheduling meetings via digital calendars (Outlook, Google Calendar) requires checking attendee availability via scheduling assistants, including agenda points, and attaching meeting links. Before attaching files, compress large folders into .zip archives and verify that sensitive documents are password-encrypted.

Workplace Context & Employer Expectations

In modern enterprises, competence in **Professional Email Etiquette, Attachments & Scheduling** is essential for data security, administrative velocity, and regulatory compliance.

✎ Personal Concept Notes & Statutory Vocabulary

D3.1

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • PROFESSIONAL EMAIL ETIQUETTE, ATTACHMENTS & SCHEDULING

Unit 6 • Step-by-Step Workflow

▶ Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Step 1:	Compose a clear subject line indicating priority and topic.
Step 2:	Draft message using concise paragraphs, bullet points for action items, and professional register.
Step 3:	Use Bcc when sending newsletters or group announcements to protect individual email addresses from public exposure.
Step 4:	Verify file size of attachments (under 10MB) and ensure file names are professional and descriptive.

✓ Productivity Tip

Create a desktop shortcut for folders used on a daily basis to eliminate navigation latency.

! Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Hitting 'Reply All' on company-wide announcements. Only reply to the sender unless everyone genuinely needs the update!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D3.1

APPLIED SCENARIO PRACTICE • SOFTWARE LAB

Unit 6 • Hands-On Practical Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 6

Scenario: You need to send a confidential staffing rota to 30 care home operatives. Draft the email, explain why Bcc must be used instead of To/Cc, and detail how you will securely password-protect the spreadsheet attachment.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Software Command Steps

Practical Drill Verification

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification:

_____

D3.1

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 6 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

Critical Security & Workflow Traps to Avoid

Trap: Examiner Trap: Hitting 'Reply All' on company-wide announcements. Only reply to the sender unless everyone genuinely needs the update!
Prevention: Always audit inputs, lock credentials with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient address fields before clicking send.

Statutory Knowledge Verification

Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Which file format preserves document formatting identically across all operating systems?

[ ] A) .txt [ ] B) .pdf [ ] C) .csv [ ] D) .rtf

2. What is the correct formula to calculate the average of cells B2 to B20?

[ ] A) =MEAN(B2:B20) [ ] B) =AVERAGE(B2:B20) [ ] C) =AVG(B2-B20)

3. Under GDPR, within how many hours must a serious personal data breach be reported?

[ ] A) 24 hours [ ] B) 48 hours [ ] C) 72 hours [ ] D) 7 days

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 3: COMMUNICATING

D3.2

Unit 7 • Video Conferencing, Collaboration Tools & Netiquette



Workplace Application: Video Conferencing, Collaboration Tools & Netiquette

▶ Core Knowledge & Statutory Standards

Virtual Meeting Platforms: Platforms like MS Teams, Zoom, and Google Meet are integral to remote teamwork. Professional meeting management involves setting meeting roles (Presenter vs Attendee), testing microphone/camera peripherals prior to commencement, and using background blur or neutral virtual backgrounds to preserve home privacy.

Collaboration Netiquette: Maintain virtual etiquette by keeping microphones muted when not speaking to eliminate background ambient noise, using the 'Raise Hand' feature to avoid interrupting speakers, and utilizing chat channels for resource links and constructive feedback. Respect digital boundaries by recording sessions only with explicit participant consent.

★ Workplace Context & Employer Expectations

In modern enterprises, competence in **Video Conferencing, Collaboration Tools & Netiquette** is essential for data security, administrative velocity, and regulatory compliance.

✎ Personal Concept Notes & Statutory Vocabulary

D3.2

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • VIDEO CONFERENCING, COLLABORATION TOOLS & NETIQUETTE

Unit 7 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Step 1:	Perform audio/video check 5 minutes before scheduled call start time.
Step 2:	Enable background blur to ensure a professional, distraction-free appearance.
Step 3:	Mute microphone upon entering and unmute only when addressing the meeting.
Step 4:	Share screen selectively (share individual application window rather than entire desktop to prevent accidental personal data display).

Productivity Tip

Create a desktop shortcut for folders used on a daily basis to eliminate navigation latency.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Sharing your entire desktop screen containing private browser tabs, emails, or personal photos. Always share only the specific presentation window!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D3.2

APPLIED SCENARIO PRACTICE • SOFTWARE LAB

Unit 7 • Hands-On Practical Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 7

Scenario: You are co-hosting a virtual workshop for 25 external clients. List the 4 key setup steps you must perform before admitting attendees from the lobby, and explain how to handle an unexpected participant disruption.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Software Command Steps

Practical Drill Verification

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification:

_____

D3.2

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 7 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Security & Workflow Traps to Avoid

Trap: Examiner Trap: Sharing your entire desktop screen containing private browser tabs, emails, or personal photos. Always share only the specific presentation window!
Prevention: Always audit inputs, lock credentials with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient address fields before clicking send.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Which file format preserves document formatting identically across all operating systems?

[ ] A) .txt [ ] B) .pdf [ ] C) .csv [ ] D) .rtf

2. What is the correct formula to calculate the average of cells B2 to B20?

[ ] A) =MEAN(B2:B20) [ ] B) =AVERAGE(B2:B20) [ ] C) =AVG(B2-B20)

3. Under GDPR, within how many hours must a serious personal data breach be reported?

[ ] A) 24 hours [ ] B) 48 hours [ ] C) 72 hours [ ] D) 7 days

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 4: TRANSACTING

D4.1

Unit 8 • E-Commerce, Online Invoicing & Secure Payment Verification



Workplace Application: E-Commerce, Online Invoicing & Secure Payment Verification

▶ Core Knowledge & Statutory Standards

Digital Commercial Transactions: Purchasing products and services online requires robust security verification. Ensure the website URL begins with `https://` (Hypertext Transfer Protocol Secure) and displays a locked padlock icon in the browser address bar, confirming that data transmitted between browser and web server is encrypted using TLS/SSL protocols.

Payment Security & Fraud Prevention: When entering payment card details, verify that the transaction requires Strong Customer Authentication (SCA) via 3D Secure (e.g. one-time passcode SMS or banking app biometric approval). Never store commercial card details on shared devices, and reconcile digital invoices against merchant receipts before approving payments.

★ Workplace Context & Employer Expectations

In modern enterprises, competence in **E-Commerce, Online Invoicing & Secure Payment Verification** is essential for data security, administrative velocity, and regulatory compliance.

✎ Personal Concept Notes & Statutory Vocabulary

D4.1

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • E-COMMERCE, ONLINE INVOICING & SECURE PAYMENT VERIFICATION

Unit 8 • Step-by-Step Workflow

▶ Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Step 1:	Verify website credentials: check for `https://`, valid SSL security certificate, and company registration details.
Step 2:	Review transaction basket: confirm quantities, VAT charges, and delivery fee calculations before proceeding.
Step 3:	Complete checkout using a secure payment gateway or protected digital wallet (Apple Pay, Google Pay, PayPal).
Step 4:	Save and archive the generated digital PDF receipt and order confirmation reference number.

✓ Productivity Tip

Create a desktop shortcut for folders used on a daily basis to eliminate navigation latency.

! Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Assuming a padlock icon proves a website is 100% legitimate. Padlocks prove the connection is encrypted, but you must still check the domain name carefully to spot spoofed fake websites!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D4.1

APPLIED SCENARIO PRACTICE • SOFTWARE LAB

Unit 8 • Hands-On Practical Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 8

Scenario: Your office manager asks you to purchase £450 of office supplies from a new online supplier. Explain 4 distinct security checks you must perform before entering company credit card details.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Software Command Steps

Practical Drill Verification

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification:

_____

D4.1

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 8 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Security & Workflow Traps to Avoid

Trap: Examiner Trap: Assuming a padlock icon proves a website is 100% legitimate. Padlocks prove the connection is encrypted, but you must still check the domain name carefully to spot spoofed fake websites!
Prevention: Always audit inputs, lock credentials with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient address fields before clicking send.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Which file format preserves document formatting identically across all operating systems?

[ ] A) .txt [ ] B) .pdf [ ] C) .csv [ ] D) .rtf

2. What is the correct formula to calculate the average of cells B2 to B20?

[ ] A) =MEAN(B2:B20) [ ] B) =AVERAGE(B2:B20) [ ] C) =AVG(B2-B20)

3. Under GDPR, within how many hours must a serious personal data breach be reported?

[ ] A) 24 hours [ ] B) 48 hours [ ] C) 72 hours [ ] D) 7 days

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 4: TRANSACTING

D4.2

Unit 9 • Digital Public Services & Official Online Accounts



Workplace Application: Digital Public Services & Official Online Accounts

▶ Core Knowledge & Statutory Standards

Accessing Public Services Online: Government and public health services in the UK are centralised through Gov.uk and NHS App portals. Accessing services (e.g. Universal Credit, DVLA vehicle tax, Council Tax billing, NHS prescriptions) requires verified digital identity accounts utilising multi-factor authentication (MFA) and National Insurance number verification.

Online Form Completion & Document Uploads: Completing digital public service applications requires entering accurate biographical details, uploading proof-of-address documents (.pdf or .jpg formats, typically under 5MB), and verifying that all input fields pass client-side data validation checks (e.g. valid postcode format, correctly formatted telephone numbers).

★ Workplace Context & Employer Expectations

In modern enterprises, competence in **Digital Public Services & Official Online Accounts** is essential for data security, administrative velocity, and regulatory compliance.

✎ Personal Concept Notes & Statutory Vocabulary

D4.2

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • DIGITAL PUBLIC SERVICES & OFFICIAL ONLINE ACCOUNTS

Unit 9 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Step 1:	Log in via official portal gateway: verify the domain ends strictly in `.gov.uk` or `.nhs.uk`.
Step 2:	Authenticate account using SMS one-time passcode or authenticator app token.
Step 3:	Complete form sections sequentially, checking progress indicators and error validation highlights.
Step 4:	Upload compressed, clear PDF copies of required utility bill or driving licence verification documents.
Step 5:	Submit application and record the unique statutory reference tracking code.

Productivity Tip

Create a desktop shortcut for folders used on a daily basis to eliminate navigation latency.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Using unofficial third-party websites that charge £40–£80 handling fees for free Gov.uk services. Always check that the URL domain ends in .gov.uk!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D4.2

APPLIED SCENARIO PRACTICE • SOFTWARE LAB

Unit 9 • Hands-On Practical Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 9

Scenario: An adult learner needs to renew their driving licence and apply for an NHS prescription online. Detail the steps required to access the genuine Gov.uk portal, verify identity, and avoid predatory copycat charging websites.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Software Command Steps

Practical Drill Verification

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification:

_____

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

D4.2

Unit 9 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Security & Workflow Traps to Avoid

Trap: Examiner Trap: Using unofficial third-party websites that charge £40–£80 handling fees for free Gov.uk services. Always check that the URL domain ends in .gov.uk!
Prevention: Always audit inputs, lock credentials with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient address fields before clicking send.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Which file format preserves document formatting identically across all operating systems?

[ ] A) .txt [ ] B) .pdf [ ] C) .csv [ ] D) .rtf

2. What is the correct formula to calculate the average of cells B2 to B20?

[ ] A) =MEAN(B2:B20) [ ] B) =AVERAGE(B2:B20) [ ] C) =AVG(B2-B20)

3. Under GDPR, within how many hours must a serious personal data breach be reported?

[ ] A) 24 hours [ ] B) 48 hours [ ] C) 72 hours [ ] D) 7 days

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 5: BEING SAFE & RESPONSIBLE ONLINE

D5.1

Unit 10 • Cybersecurity Hygiene, Phishing Detection & UK GDPR



Workplace Application: Cybersecurity Hygiene, Phishing Detection & UK GDPR

Core Knowledge & Statutory Standards

Cyber Threats & Social Engineering: The vast majority of cyber breaches stem from human deception rather than technical flaws. **Phishing:** Fraudulent emails imitating banks, delivery couriers, or HMRC attempting to harvest login credentials. Key red flags include urgent threatening language (*'Your account will be suspended within 24 hours'*), generic greetings (*'Dear Customer'*), and spoofed sender email addresses (e.g. `support@paypal-security-alert.co.uk` instead of `@paypal.com`).

Password Security & 2FA: Create strong, memorable passphrases using three random words combined with numbers and symbols (e.g. `Castle$Pebble97Breeze!`). Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) across all professional accounts. **UK GDPR & Data Protection:** Handle personal identifiable data (PID) strictly according to the 7 UK GDPR principles: lawfulness, purpose limitation, data minimisation, accuracy, storage limitation, integrity/confidentiality, and accountability.

Workplace Context & Employer Expectations

In modern enterprises, competence in **Cybersecurity Hygiene, Phishing Detection & UK GDPR** is essential for data security, administrative velocity, and regulatory compliance.

✎ Personal Concept Notes & Statutory Vocabulary

D5.1

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • CYBERSECURITY HYGIENE, PHISHING DETECTION & UK GDPR

Unit 10 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Step 1:	Hover mouse over hyperlinks in emails to reveal the actual destination URL before clicking.
Step 2:	Verify sender header email address carefully to detect domain spoofing.
Step 3:	Implement multi-factor authentication (MFA) across email, banking, and cloud storage systems.
Step 4:	Never share passwords via unencrypted messaging apps or write them on sticky notes.
Step 5:	Immediately report suspected security incidents or accidental data disclosures to the Data Protection Officer (DPO).

Productivity Tip

Create a desktop shortcut for folders used on a daily basis to eliminate navigation latency.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Believing that anti-virus software alone provides complete protection. Human vigilance and skepticism are the ultimate line of defence against social engineering!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D5.1

APPLIED SCENARIO PRACTICE • SOFTWARE LAB

Unit 10 • Hands-On Practical Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 10

Scenario: You receive an urgent email purporting to be from the IT Support team requesting you to verify your employee email password via an external link. Identify 3 warning signs of phishing and outline your exact response protocol.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Software Command Steps

Practical Drill Verification

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification:

_____

D5.1

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 10 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Security & Workflow Traps to Avoid

Trap: Examiner Trap: Believing that anti-virus software alone provides complete protection. Human vigilance and skepticism are the ultimate line of defence against social engineering!
Prevention: Always audit inputs, lock credentials with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient address fields before clicking send.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Which file format preserves document formatting identically across all operating systems?

[ ] A) .txt [ ] B) .pdf [ ] C) .csv [ ] D) .rtf

2. What is the correct formula to calculate the average of cells B2 to B20?

[ ] A) =MEAN(B2:B20) [ ] B) =AVERAGE(B2:B20) [ ] C) =AVG(B2-B20)

3. Under GDPR, within how many hours must a serious personal data breach be reported?

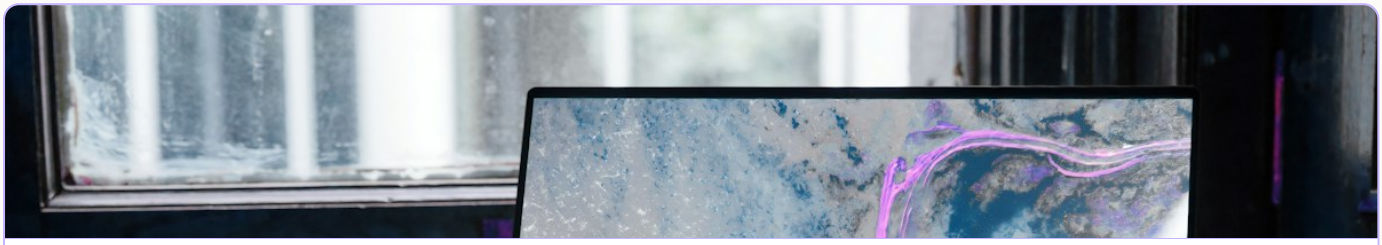
[ ] A) 24 hours [ ] B) 48 hours [ ] C) 72 hours [ ] D) 7 days

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary

ME1.1

PRACTICAL EXAM 1: PRACTICAL MOCK 1: ADMINISTRATIVE OPERATIONS & DOCUMENT PROCESSING

Mock Exam 1 • Scenario Overview



Examination Context: Practical Mock 1: Administrative Operations & Document Processing

Candidate Briefing • 50 Marks • 1 hr 45 mins

Scenario Context: You are working as an Administrative Officer for a regional vocational training academy. The centre manager has tasked you with auditing and restructuring the new apprentice onboarding digital toolkit.

Task 1 (File Hierarchy & Storage Architecture): Task 1: Establish a standardized hierarchical folder structure for 30 new apprentices across 3 vocational sectors (Healthcare, Engineering, Digital). **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Working Grid • Folder Architecture & File Paths

ME1.2

PRACTICAL EXAM 1: PRACTICAL MOCK 1: ADMINISTRATIVE OPERATIONS & DOCUMENT PROCESSING

Mock Exam 1 • Task 2 (Spreadsheet Modeling)

Task 2 (Spreadsheet Calculations & Formatting): Task 2: Format an Apprentice Induction Handbook in Word using styles (Title, Heading 1, Heading 2), inserting an automated Table of Contents and an accessible table of key dates. **[15 Marks]**

✎ **Candidate Working Grid • Formula Syntax (=SUM, =AVERAGE, =IF)**

★ **Formula Verification Checklist**

Verify: (1) Absolute cell references (B1) are locked where appropriate. (2) Currency formatting applied (£0.00). (3) Gridlines visible for printing.

ME1.3

PRACTICAL EXAM 1: PRACTICAL MOCK 1: ADMINISTRATIVE OPERATIONS & DOCUMENT PROCESSING

Mock Exam 1 • Task 3 (Email & Communication)

Task 3 (Professional Workplace Correspondence): Task 3: Conduct research to identify statutory minimum wage rates for apprentices, citing two verified .gov.uk sources using proper search operators. **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Email Drafting Area (Subject, Salutation, Body, Sign-Off)

PRACTICAL EXAM 1: PRACTICAL MOCK 1: ADMINISTRATIVE OPERATIONS & DOCUMENT PROCESSING

ME1.4

Mock Exam 1 • Task 4 (Security Incident)

Task 4 (Cybersecurity Incident Triage & Reporting): Task 4: Draft a professional welcome email to apprentices using appropriate To, Cc, and Bcc fields to distribute the handbook while protecting private personal email addresses. **[11 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Incident Triage & Action Report

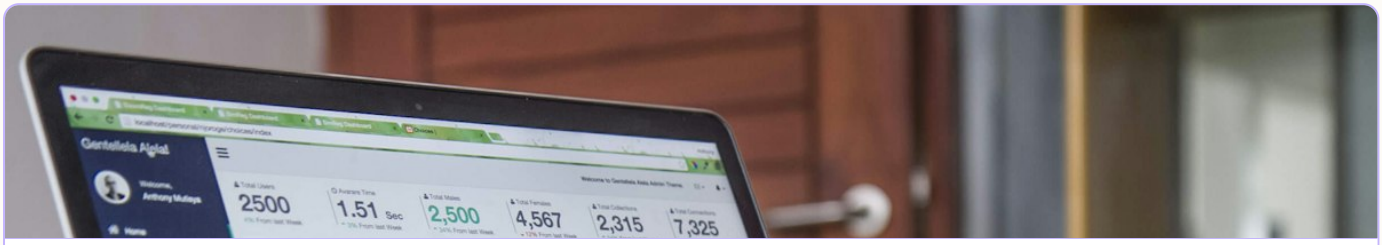
▶ Practical Exam Summary & Sign-Off

Mock 1 Total Marks: _____ / 50 **Status: [ ] Pass [ ] Refer** **Examiner: _____**

ME2.1

PRACTICAL EXAM 2: PRACTICAL MOCK 2: RETAIL INVENTORY SPREADSHEET & COMMERCIAL ACCOUNTING

Mock Exam 2 • Scenario Overview



Examination Context: Practical Mock 2: Retail Inventory Spreadsheet & Commercial Accounting

▶ Candidate Briefing • 50 Marks • 1 hr 45 mins

Scenario Context: You are the Operations Assistant for a growing eco-friendly home goods retailer. The business needs a dynamic, automated inventory tracking and customer billing spreadsheet.

Task 1 (File Hierarchy & Storage Architecture): Task 1: Construct an inventory management spreadsheet with 15 stock lines, applying formulas for Line Total (=Unit Cost * Quantity), VAT at 20%, and Gross Retail Value. **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Working Grid • Folder Architecture & File Paths

PRACTICAL EXAM 2: PRACTICAL MOCK 2: RETAIL INVENTORY SPREADSHEET & COMMERCIAL ACCOUNTING

ME2.2

Mock Exam 2 • Task 2 (Spreadsheet Modeling)

Task 2 (Spreadsheet Calculations & Formatting): Task 2: Use summary formulas =SUM, =AVERAGE, =MIN, and =MAX to extract key operational metrics across the stock inventory. **[15 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Working Grid • Formula Syntax (=SUM, =AVERAGE, =IF)

★ Formula Verification Checklist

Verify: (1) Absolute cell references (B1) are locked where appropriate. (2) Currency formatting applied (£0.00). (3) Gridlines visible for printing.

PRACTICAL EXAM 2: PRACTICAL MOCK 2: RETAIL INVENTORY SPREADSHEET & COMMERCIAL ACCOUNTING

ME2.3

Mock Exam 2 • Task 3 (Email & Communication)

Task 3 (Professional Workplace Correspondence): Task 3: Apply an automated =IF function to Column G to flag 'RESTOCK REQUIRED' for any item falling below 12 units. **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Email Drafting Area (Subject, Salutation, Body, Sign-Off)

PRACTICAL EXAM 2: PRACTICAL MOCK 2: RETAIL INVENTORY SPREADSHEET & COMMERCIAL ACCOUNTING

ME2.4

Mock Exam 2 • Task 4 (Security Incident)

Task 4 (Cybersecurity Incident Triage & Reporting): Task 4: Generate a high-contrast Clustered Bar Chart illustrating stock value by product category, complete with labeled axes and data labels. **[11 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Incident Triage & Action Report

▶ Practical Exam Summary & Sign-Off

Mock 2 Total Marks: _____ / 50 **Status: [ ] Pass [ ] Refer** **Examiner: _____**

ME3.1

PRACTICAL EXAM 3: PRACTICAL MOCK 3: DIGITAL CUSTOMER CARE & SECURE COMMUNICATIONS

Mock Exam 3 • Scenario Overview



Examination Context: Practical Mock 3: Digital Customer Care & Secure Communications

Candidate Briefing • 50 Marks • 1 hr 45 mins

Scenario Context: You are a Customer Experience Coordinator for a community health trust. You must handle digital communications, appointment scheduling, and patient data requests with strict adherence to privacy.

Task 1 (File Hierarchy & Storage Architecture): Task 1: Schedule a series of virtual consultation meetings in MS Teams, configuring presenter permissions, lobby security, and calendar invites. **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Working Grid • Folder Architecture & File Paths

PRACTICAL EXAM 3: PRACTICAL MOCK 3: DIGITAL CUSTOMER CARE & SECURE COMMUNICATIONS

ME3.2

Mock Exam 3 • Task 2 (Spreadsheet Modeling)

Task 2 (Spreadsheet Calculations & Formatting): Task 2: Respond to a patient inquiry via email, maintaining empathetic professional register and attaching a guidance document encrypted with password protection. **[15 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Working Grid • Formula Syntax (=SUM, =AVERAGE, =IF)

★ Formula Verification Checklist

Verify: (1) Absolute cell references (B1) are locked where appropriate. (2) Currency formatting applied (£0.00). (3) Gridlines visible for printing.

ME3.3

PRACTICAL EXAM 3: PRACTICAL MOCK 3: DIGITAL CUSTOMER CARE & SECURE COMMUNICATIONS

Mock Exam 3 • Task 3 (Email & Communication)

Task 3 (Professional Workplace Correspondence): Task 3: Identify a suspicious incoming email claiming to represent NHS procurement, documenting 4 clear phishing indicators in an incident log. **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Email Drafting Area (Subject, Salutation, Body, Sign-Off)

PRACTICAL EXAM 3: PRACTICAL MOCK 3: DIGITAL CUSTOMER CARE & SECURE COMMUNICATIONS

ME3.4

Mock Exam 3 • Task 4 (Security Incident)

Task 4 (Cybersecurity Incident Triage & Reporting): Task 4: Outline the procedure for handling a Subject Access Request (SAR) under UK GDPR, specifying the statutory response deadline (1 calendar month). **[11 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Incident Triage & Action Report

▶ Practical Exam Summary & Sign-Off

Mock 3 Total Marks: _____ / 50 **Status: [ ] Pass [ ] Refer** **Examiner: _____**

PRACTICAL EXAM 4: PRACTICAL MOCK 4: CORPORATE DATA SECURITY AUDIT & TECHNOLOGY GOVERNANCE

ME4.1

Mock Exam 4 • Scenario Overview



Examination Context: Practical Mock 4: Corporate Data Security Audit & Technology Governance

Candidate Briefing • 50 Marks • 1 hr 45 mins

Scenario Context: You are supporting the Information Governance lead in preparing an organization for Cyber Essentials certification and statutory data compliance.

Task 1 (File Hierarchy & Storage Architecture): Task 1: Conduct a password hygiene and 2FA compliance audit across 40 user accounts, identifying 5 critical security vulnerabilities. **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Working Grid • Folder Architecture & File Paths

PRACTICAL EXAM 4: PRACTICAL MOCK 4: CORPORATE DATA SECURITY AUDIT & TECHNOLOGY GOVERNANCE

ME4.2

Mock Exam 4 • Task 2 (Spreadsheet Modeling)

Task 2 (Spreadsheet Calculations & Formatting): Task 2: Formulate an acceptable cloud storage policy restricting the storage of sensitive personal data on unencrypted personal mobile devices. **[15 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Working Grid • Formula Syntax (=SUM, =AVERAGE, =IF)

★ Formula Verification Checklist

Verify: (1) Absolute cell references (B1) are locked where appropriate. (2) Currency formatting applied (£0.00). (3) Gridlines visible for printing.

ME4.3

PRACTICAL EXAM 4: PRACTICAL MOCK 4: CORPORATE DATA SECURITY AUDIT & TECHNOLOGY GOVERNANCE

Mock Exam 4 • Task 3 (Email & Communication)

Task 3 (Professional Workplace Correspondence): Task 3: Evaluate 3 online payment gateway solutions for the corporate website, verifying SSL/TLS certificates and PCI-DSS compliance. **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Email Drafting Area (Subject, Salutation, Body, Sign-Off)

PRACTICAL EXAM 4: PRACTICAL MOCK 4: CORPORATE DATA SECURITY AUDIT & TECHNOLOGY GOVERNANCE

ME4.4

Mock Exam 4 • Task 4 (Security Incident)

Task 4 (Cybersecurity Incident Triage & Reporting): Task 4: Create a 6-slide staff training presentation on social engineering awareness, applying WCAG 2.1 accessibility standards and Alt-Text graphics. **[11 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Incident Triage & Action Report

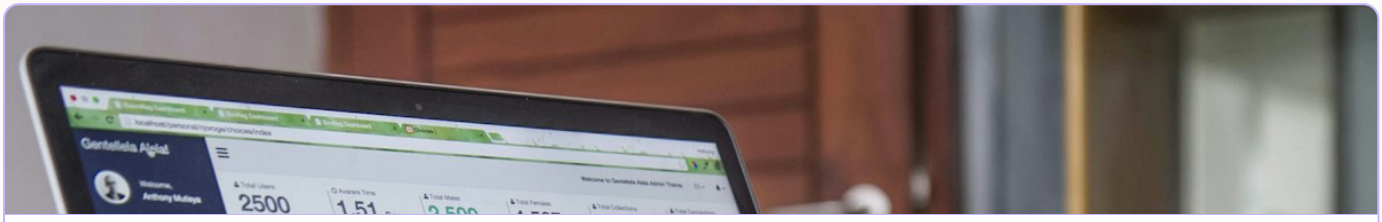
▶ Practical Exam Summary & Sign-Off

Mock 4 Total Marks: _____ / 50 **Status: [ ] Pass [ ] Refer** **Examiner: _____**

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 1: THEORY & SOP

LAB1

Lab 1: Cloud Storage Architecture & Access Permissions



Enterprise cloud directory structures, multi-tenant sharing, and permission hierarchies.

Workplace Technical Architecture & Governance

Cloud Security Framework: In enterprise environments (SharePoint, Google Drive, Nextcloud), granting blanket 'Edit' access to root folders introduces critical data loss risks. Standard practice mandates three distinct permission tiers: (1) *View/Read-Only* for general staff reference documents; (2) *Commenter* for cross-departmental reviewers; (3) *Owner/Editor* restricted to designated project managers.

Version History & Audit Trails: When multiple team members collaborate asynchronously, file synchronization conflicts frequently overwrite crucial data. Cloud versioning allows administrators to inspect previous timestamps, compare differences, and restore stable revisions.

Standard Operating Checklist: Tiered Permissions

1. Root Folder Provisioning:	Create a structured project folder with format: `[Dept]_[ProjectName]_[Year]`.
2. Subfolder Partitioning:	Establish segregated subfolders: `01_Reference` (Read-Only), `02_WIP` (Edit for Team), `03_Confidential` (Restricted).
3. Link Security Configuration:	Disable 'Anyone with the link' public sharing. Enforce organizational email domain authentication with 30-day password expiry.

✎ Personal Implementation Notes & Software Shortcuts

LAB1

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 2: HANDS-ON LAB

LAB1 • Applied Workplace Hands-On Task

Applied Workplace Scenario & Lab Task

Scenario: You are deploying a shared cloud workspace for a regional healthcare recruitment drive involving 40 confidential applicant CVs and an open interviewer schedule.

Required Lab Deliverables:

1. Diagram a 3-tier folder structure ensuring interviewers cannot edit master candidate scorecards.
2. Write the exact permission settings (Read-only, Edit, Restricted) for 3 distinct user groups.
3. Outline the 4-step emergency recovery procedure if an interviewer accidentally deletes the schedule.

✎ Candidate Command Steps & Technical Implementation Log

Software Lab Sign-Off & Competency Endorsement

Lab Task Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Lead Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

LAB2

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 1: THEORY & SOP

Lab 2: Advanced Spreadsheet Modeling & Data Validation



Formulas, absolute referencing, conditional formatting, and error diagnostics.

Workplace Technical Architecture & Governance

Mathematical Rigor in Spreadsheets: Workplace spreadsheets drive payroll, procurement, and financial forecasting. A single missing dollar sign in an absolute reference (e.g. `B$1` vs `B1`) can distort thousand-pound calculations across autofilled columns.

Data Validation Protocols: Restricting user input to pre-configured dropdown lists (e.g. Approved Expense Categories) prevents typographical errors that break lookup formulas like `=VLOOKUP()` and `=XLOOKUP()`.

Standard Operating Checklist: Formula Modeling

1. Absolute Cell Locking:	Lock tax rates or exchange rate parameters using $ syntax (e.g. `=A2 * $E$1`) before dragging fill handles.
2. Dynamic Dropdown Lists:	Implement Data Validation → List → specify source range to enforce uniform category naming conventions.
3. Conditional Alerts:	Apply conditional formatting rules to highlight values exceeding budget limits in bold red with light pink shading.

✎ Personal Implementation Notes & Software Shortcuts

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 2: HANDS-ON LAB

LAB2

LAB2 • Applied Workplace Hands-On Task

Applied Workplace Scenario & Lab Task

Scenario: You are designing an automated departmental petty cash and travel reimbursement model for 15 field technicians.

Required Lab Deliverables:

1. Construct the formula to calculate mileage allowance (£0.45/mile) referencing locked cell `$C$1`.
2. Write the syntax for an `=IF()` statement that flags any expense over £100 as 'REQUIRES SENIOR SIGN-OFF'.
3. Detail how to identify and resolve a `#VALUE!` error caused by text characters in a numerical column.

✎ Candidate Command Steps & Technical Implementation Log

Software Lab Sign-Off & Competency Endorsement

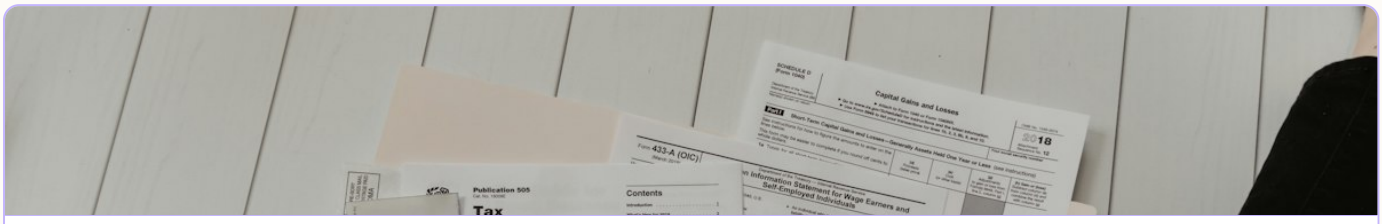
Lab Task Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Lead Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

LAB3

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 1: THEORY & SOP

Lab 3: Professional Business Correspondence & Netiquette



Email architecture, confidentiality etiquette, thread management, and calendar invites.

Workplace Technical Architecture & Governance

Professional Email Architecture: Business email is a permanent legal record. Messages must possess a concise, descriptive subject line (e.g. `[URGENT] Q3 Financial Audit Review - Action Required by 17:00`), professional salutation, structured body paragraphs, and a compliant corporate signature banner.

The Confidentiality Imperative (CC vs BCC): The UK Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) penalizes organizations thousands of pounds for exposing customer email addresses by using the CC field instead of BCC during group mailings.

Standard Operating Checklist: Email Governance

1. Subject Line Protocol:	Always include project prefix, topic summary, and response deadline.
2. BCC Privacy Rule:	Any distribution list to external clients or patients MUST utilize BCC to comply with UK Data Protection regulations.
3. Meeting Invitation Workflow:	Include agenda bullet points, video conference URL, and attachments directly within calendar invites.

✎ Personal Implementation Notes & Software Shortcuts

LAB3

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 2: HANDS-ON LAB

LAB3 • Applied Workplace Hands-On Task

Applied Workplace Scenario & Lab Task

Scenario: A critical delivery of medical training equipment has been delayed by 72 hours, impacting a scheduled apprentice certification day.

Required Lab Deliverables:

1. Draft the formal email to the Lead Course Instructor acknowledging the delay and presenting two contingency solutions.
2. Explain why individual student email addresses must be placed in BCC rather than CC.
3. Create a structured calendar meeting invitation with agenda to review contingency options at 08:30 tomorrow.

✎ Candidate Command Steps & Technical Implementation Log

Software Lab Sign-Off & Competency Endorsement

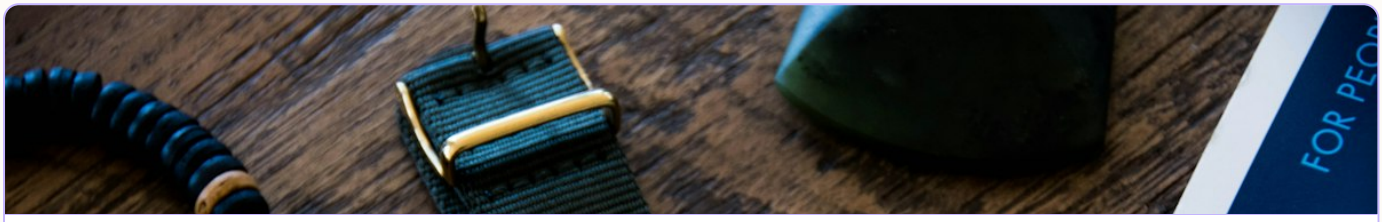
Lab Task Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Lead Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 1: THEORY & SOP

LAB4

Lab 4: Cybersecurity Vulnerability Triage & Phishing Defense



Detecting social engineering, spoofed domains, ransomware vectors, and incident logging.

Workplace Technical Architecture & Governance

Anatomy of Social Engineering: Modern cyber attacks rarely exploit raw software vulnerabilities; they exploit human psychology. Phishing attacks manufacture urgency (e.g. 'Your account will be suspended within 2 hours!'), impersonate trusted authority figures (CEOs, IT helpdesk), and conceal malicious URLs behind misleading anchor text.

Incident Escalation Protocols: When a phishing link is clicked or credentials are inadvertently entered, immediate isolation of the device from the network is mandatory to prevent malware propagation.

Standard Operating Checklist: Threat Triage

1. Header & Domain Inspection:	Verify sender email domain exactly (e.g. `@hmrc-tax-refund.co.uk` vs legitimate `@hmrc.gov.uk`).
2. Link Destination Hover:	Hover without clicking to inspect the true hyperlinked URL in the browser status bar.
3. Incident Escalation:	Disconnect Wi-Fi / ethernet immediately, notify InfoSec officer, and log incident details.

✎ Personal Implementation Notes & Software Shortcuts

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 2: HANDS-ON LAB

LAB4

LAB4 • Applied Workplace Hands-On Task

Applied Workplace Scenario & Lab Task

Scenario: An employee in accounts payable receives an urgent email appearing to come from the Managing Director requesting an immediate £8,500 bank transfer to an unknown vendor account.

Required Lab Deliverables:

1. Identify 4 distinct red flags that indicate this email is a Business Email Compromise (BEC) attack.
2. Complete a statutory 4-point Cybersecurity Incident Triage Log.
3. Outline the verification protocol required before any unusual financial transfer is authorized.

✎ Candidate Command Steps & Technical Implementation Log

Software Lab Sign-Off & Competency Endorsement

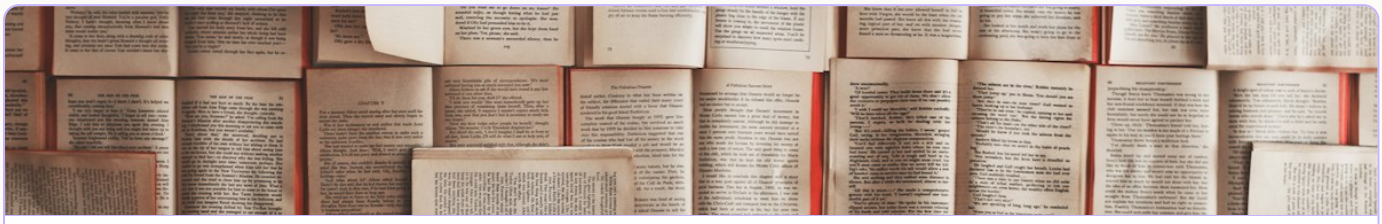
Lab Task Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Lead Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 1: THEORY & SOP

LAB5

Lab 5: Corporate Document Processing & Accessibility



Semantic heading styles, automated TOC, alt-text for screen readers, and PDF conversion.

Workplace Technical Architecture & Governance

Document Accessibility Standards (WCAG 2.1): Corporate publications, patient guides, and training manuals must be accessible to individuals using assistive technologies (screen readers, braille displays). Merely enlarging font size and making text bold does not create a true heading.

Semantic Structure & Automation: Applying true Heading Styles (Heading 1, Heading 2, Heading 3) allows screen readers to navigate document outlines and enables word processors to generate instant, perfectly formatted Tables of Contents.

Standard Operating Checklist: Document Accessibility

1. Semantic Hierarchy:	Apply Heading 1 for document titles, Heading 2 for major chapters, Heading 3 for subsections.
2. Visual Accessibility:	Ensure minimum text contrast ratio of 4.5:1. Never convey meaning through color alone.
3. Alternative Text (Alt-Text):	Provide concise descriptions of functional images, charts, and diagrams for screen readers.

✎ Personal Implementation Notes & Software Shortcuts

LAB5

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 2: HANDS-ON LAB

LAB5 • Applied Workplace Hands-On Task

Applied Workplace Scenario & Lab Task

Scenario: You are standardizing a 12-page unformatted draft of the company Employee Health & Safety Handbook.

Required Lab Deliverables:

1. Reorganize the provided raw text outline into a semantic Heading 1 → Heading 2 → Heading 3 hierarchy.
2. Write appropriate, descriptive Alt-Text for an infographic showing workplace emergency evacuation routes.
3. Describe the 3 checks required before exporting the document as an accessible, tagged PDF/A file.

✎ Candidate Command Steps & Technical Implementation Log

Software Lab Sign-Off & Competency Endorsement

Lab Task Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Lead Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 1: THEORY & SOP

LAB6

Lab 6: Online Research, Source Reliability & Copyright Compliance



The CRAAP evaluation model, copyright licensing, Creative Commons, and data synthesis.

Workplace Technical Architecture & Governance

Information Literacy in the Digital Age: The internet offers boundless information alongside rampant misinformation, biased editorializing, and outdated technical claims. Workplace professionals must systematically evaluate online sources using the CRAAP test: Currency, Relevance, Authority, Accuracy, and Purpose.

Intellectual Property & Licensing: Commercial reuse of text, imagery, or software code without explicit licensing exposes organizations to severe legal copyright infringement claims under the Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988.

Standard Operating Checklist: Information Verification

1. Currency & Authority Audit:	Verify publication date and author credentials (peer-reviewed, government statistical agency, or recognized trade body).
2. Cross-Verification Rule:	Never cite a critical statistic without confirming it across at least two independent primary sources.
3. Licensing Compliance:	Verify Creative Commons licenses (CC-BY, CC-SA). Avoid CC-NC assets in commercial business publications.

✎ Personal Implementation Notes & Software Shortcuts

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 2: HANDS-ON LAB

LAB6

LAB6 • Applied Workplace Hands-On Task

Applied Workplace Scenario & Lab Task

Scenario: You are conducting market research to advise executive directors on choosing an commercial cloud telephone system (VoIP).

Required Lab Deliverables:

1. Apply the 5 criteria of the CRAAP test to evaluate a vendor promotional white paper vs a consumer watchdog report.
2. Explain the legal restrictions of using a 'Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial (CC BY-NC)' image in a commercial company brochure.
3. Compile an annotated corporate research brief comparing two verified telecom providers.

✎ Candidate Command Steps & Technical Implementation Log

Software Lab Sign-Off & Competency Endorsement

Lab Task Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Lead Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

IT.REF1

STATUTORY STANDARDS & WORKPLACE IT FRAMEWORK

Workplace File Format & Extension Directory



Comprehensive classification of corporate file formats, compression algorithms, and application associations.

Workplace Technical Specification & Architecture

Extension	Category	Associated Software	Security & Compatibility Notes
.pdf	Document	Adobe Acrobat / Edge	Preserves formatting across platforms; read-only default.
.docx / .odt	Word Processing	Word / LibreOffice	Standard editable documents. May harbor malicious macros.
.xlsx / .csv	Spreadsheet	Excel / Google Sheets	.csv is plain text without formulas; .xlsx supports formulas and charts.
.png / .jpg	Raster Image	Photos / Browser	.png supports transparency; .jpg provides high photographic compression.
.zip / .tar.gz	Archive	WinZip / 7-Zip	Bundles and compresses multiple files; scan before extraction.
.exe / .bat	Executable	Windows OS Core	Executes code directly. **Extreme danger in email attachments!**

Core Professional Compliance Mandate

Golden Rule: Never double-click an executable attachment (.exe, .scr, .vbs) received via email, even if the sender appears familiar!

✎ Personal Implementation Notes & Enterprise Protocols

STATUTORY STANDARDS & WORKPLACE IT FRAMEWORK

IT.REF2

Spreadsheet Error Diagnostics & Function Syntax



Troubleshooting calculation errors, reference issues, and syntax anomalies under pressure.

Workplace Technical Specification & Architecture

Error Code	Root Cause	Remediation Step
#DIV/0!	Dividing by zero or an empty cell.	Wrap formula in `=IF(B2=0, 0, A2/B2)` to handle zero values safely.
#VALUE!	Mathematical operation performed on text string.	Verify that referenced cells contain purely numerical digits, not symbols.
#REF!	Cell referenced in formula was deleted.	Undo deletion (`Ctrl + Z`) or re-point the formula to the correct active coordinate.
#NAME?	Misspelled function name (e.g. `=AVRAGE`).	Correct spelling to standard syntax: `=AVERAGE()`, `=SUM()`, `=COUNT()`.
#####	Column width is too narrow to display the number.	Double-click column boundary header line to autofit column width.

Core Professional Compliance Mandate

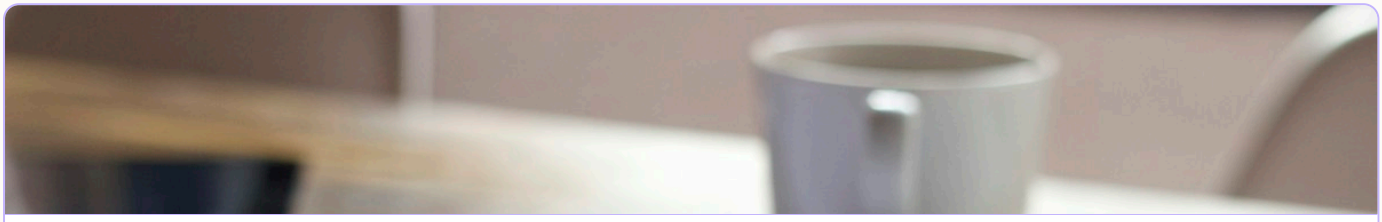
Pro-Tip: Always use the Formula Auditing toolbar (Trace Precedents / Trace Dependents) to visualize how formulas link across large workbooks.

✎ Personal Implementation Notes & Enterprise Protocols

STATUTORY STANDARDS & WORKPLACE IT FRAMEWORK

IT.REF3

Cybersecurity Incident Escalation & GDPR Action Flowchart



Statutory protocols for reporting unauthorized data disclosures and suspected cyber intrusions.

Workplace Technical Specification & Architecture

Phase 1 • Immediate Containment (Minutes 0–15):
• Disconnect device from Wi-Fi/Ethernet immediately. Do NOT turn off the computer (preserves forensic volatile RAM memory).
• Alert immediate line manager and designated Information Security Officer.

Phase 2 • Investigation & Triage (Hours 1–24):
• Determine category of breached data: Does it contain Special Category PII (medical records, biometric data, financial details)?
• Audit access logs to establish extent of unauthorized extraction.

Phase 3 • Statutory Regulatory Disclosure (Within 72 Hours):
• Under Article 33 of UK GDPR, the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) must be notified within 72 hours of becoming aware of a high-risk personal data breach.
• Notify affected data subjects without undue delay if risk to their rights and freedoms is significant.

Core Professional Compliance Mandate

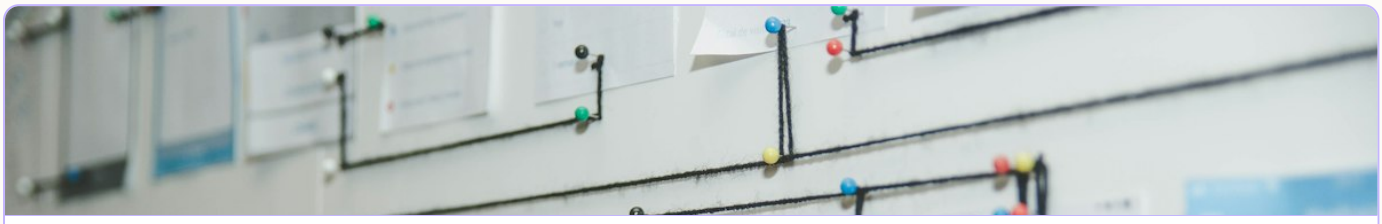
Legal Mandate: Fines for non-reporting under UK GDPR can reach £17.5 million or 4% of global annual turnover, whichever is greater.

✎ Personal Implementation Notes & Enterprise Protocols

STATUTORY STANDARDS & WORKPLACE IT FRAMEWORK

IT.REF4

Workplace Digital Hygiene & Device Ergonomics Audit



Personal compliance audit for password security, multi-factor tokens, and postural health.

Workplace Technical Specification & Architecture

Digital Security Hygiene Checklist:

[ ] Passphrases consist of three random, memorable words (minimum 14 characters).
[ ] Multi-factor authentication (MFA) enabled on email, cloud drives, and internal portals.
[ ] Lock workstation screen (`Win + L`) whenever stepping away from desk.
[ ] Automatic software updates and anti-virus definitions set to auto-install overnight.
[ ] Work files saved exclusively on encrypted cloud backup drives, never on local desktop.

Health & Safety DSE Ergonomic Checklist:

[ ] Top of computer monitor positioned at eye level; distance 50–70 cm from face.
[ ] Forearms rest horizontal to desk surface; wrists remain straight during typing.
[ ] Lumbar spine supported by adjustable ergonomic backrest; feet flat on floor or footrest.
[ ] 20-20-20 rule implemented: Every 20 minutes, look at an object 20 feet away for 20 seconds.

Core Professional Compliance Mandate

Lead Instructor Endorsement: Maintaining daily digital hygiene and physical ergonomics ensures long-term career productivity and regulatory compliance.

✎ Personal Implementation Notes & Enterprise Protocols

OFFICIAL SOLUTIONS, SHORTCUTS & REFERENCE DIRECTORY

Complete Practical Workflow Solutions & Statutory Guidance

UNIT 1 • DEVICE SETUP & SAFETY DRILL

Step 1 (Workstation Ergonomics): Position screen 50-70 cm from eyes at eye level. Adjust chair height so elbows rest at 90 degrees.
Step 2 (Peripheral Cable Management): Route cables through desk grommets; avoid trip hazards.
Knowledge Check: Minimum strong password length recommended by UK NCSC is **12-16 characters** (three random words method).

UNIT 2 • FILE MANAGEMENT & HIERARCHY DRILL

Folder Architecture: `Company_Drive / 2026_Operations / Logistics / Invoices / 2026-10-14_Invoice_Apex.pdf`.
Naming Convention Rule: Use ISO date format `YYYY-MM-DD` followed by descriptive project name; never use spaces or special characters (#, %, &).

UNIT 3 • DIGITAL INFORMATION & SEARCH DRILL

Search Operators: Use quotation marks for exact phrase (`"fleet electrification case study"`), minus sign to exclude (`-hybrid`), and `filetype:pdf` for technical reports.
Evaluating Reliability: Check author credentials, publication date, domain authority (.gov.uk, .ac.uk), and cross-reference corroborating sources.

UNIT 4 • SPREADSHEET FORMULAS & FUNCTIONS DRILL

Formulas:
• Total Revenue: `=SUM(C2:C15)`
• Average Order Value: `=AVERAGE(D2:D15)`
• Bonus Threshold: `=IF(E2>10000, E2*0.05, 0)`
• VAT Calculation: `=F2*B1` (where B1 holds 0.20).

UNIT 5 • PROFESSIONAL WORKPLACE EMAIL DRILL

Email Layout: Clear subject line (`Project Update: Q3 Audit Report Complete`), formal salutation (`Dear Ms Henderson,`), concise three-paragraph body, attachment confirmation, polite sign-off (`Kind regards, Abdul`).

UNIT 6 • CLOUD COLLABORATION & PERMISSIONS DRILL

Sharing Tiers: Assign '**Viewer**' for external clients, '**Commenter**' for review committees, and '**Editor**' strictly to assigned document authors. Enable link expiration after 14 days.

UNIT 7 • CYBERSECURITY & PHISHING DRILL

Phishing Red Flags: Mismatched sender domain (e.g. `@support-paypal-update.com` instead of official domain), artificial urgency (*'Account suspended within 2 hours!'*), generic greeting, and suspicious hyperlink target.

UNIT 8 • ONLINE SAFETY & GDPR COMPLIANCE DRILL

GDPR Rules: Obtain explicit consent before data capture, store personal identifiable information (PII) on encrypted servers, delete records once operational purpose expires, and report data breaches within 72 hours.

UNIT 9 • VIDEO CONFERENCING & VIRTUAL MEETINGS DRILL

Meeting Protocol: Test microphone and webcam prior to joining, mute microphone when not speaking to eliminate background noise, use blurred or neutral background, and distribute meeting agenda 24 hours in advance.

UNIT 10 • HARDWARE DIAGNOSTICS & TROUBLESHOOTING DRILL

Diagnostic Workflow: Check physical power cable → Inspect Wi-Fi router status LEDs → Renew IP address via command line (`ipconfig /renew`) → Restart device → Escalate to IT Helpdesk if hardware fault.

MOCK 1 • OFFICE RELOCATION PROJECT SIMULATION

Task 1 (Hierarchy): Created folders `01_Floor_Plans`, `02_Vendor_Quotes`, `03_Staff_Allocations`.
Task 2 (Budget Spreadsheet): Input formula `=SUM(D4:D18)` for subtotal; `=D19*0.2` for VAT; `=D19+D20` for gross expenditure.
Task 3 (Executive Briefing): Drafted 250-word memo detailing moving dates, IT downtime schedule, and parking pass reallocation.
Task 4 (Cloud Access): Set shared folder permissions to 'Restricted' with multi-factor authentication required.

MOCK 2 • CUSTOMER SERVICE DATA ANALYTICS SIMULATION

Task 1 (Spreadsheet Analytics): Filtered customer complaint log by category; calculated resolution percentage with `=COUNTIF(E2:E100, "Resolved")/COUNTA(E2:E100)`.
Task 2 (Chart Generation): Plotted 2D clustered column chart displaying average response times across four quarterly departments.
Task 3 (Professional Email): Formulated sensitive apology email addressing customer shipping delay, offering voucher code and tracking link.

OFFICIAL SOLUTIONS, SHORTCUTS & REFERENCE DIRECTORY (CONTINUED)

MOCK 3 • HEALTH & SAFETY COMPLIANCE PORTAL SIMULATION

Task 1 (Intranet Form): Built online accident reporting form with required fields for employee ID, incident date, and severity level.
Task 2 (Data Validation): Configured input restriction allowing only dates within past 7 days and dropdown list for injury classification.
Task 3 (GDPR Audit): Removed employee national insurance numbers from public shared spreadsheet and archived onto encrypted local drive.

MOCK 4 • CYBERSECURITY INCIDENT RESPONSE SIMULATION

Task 1 (Incident Triage): Disconnected compromised workstation from local network immediately (pulled Ethernet cable / disabled Wi-Fi).
Task 2 (Breach Log): Recorded incident timestamp, compromised account username, and suspicious email header details.
Task 3 (Password Reset): Guided user through setting up a 16-character passphrase and re-registering authenticator token.
Task 4 (Action Report): Submitted official security event notification to Data Protection Officer within 1 hour.

UNIVERSAL OPERATING SYSTEM & BROWSER SHORTCUTS

Universal Operating System Shortcuts (Windows / macOS):

- Copy: `Ctrl + C` (Win) / `Cmd + C` (Mac)
- Paste: `Ctrl + V` (Win) / `Cmd + V` (Mac)
- Cut: `Ctrl + X` (Win) / `Cmd + X` (Mac)
- Undo / Redo: `Ctrl + Z` / `Ctrl + Y`
- Select All: `Ctrl + A`
- Find in Page: `Ctrl + F`
- Save Document: `Ctrl + S`
- Print / Save as PDF: `Ctrl + P`
- Lock Workstation: `Win + L`
- File Explorer: `Win + E`
- Task Manager: `Ctrl + Shift + Esc`

Web Browser Shortcuts (Chrome / Edge / Firefox):

- New Tab: `Ctrl + T` Close Tab: `Ctrl + W`
- Reopen Closed Tab: `Ctrl + Shift + T`
- Incognito / InPrivate: `Ctrl + Shift + N`
- Bookmark Current Page: `Ctrl + D`
- Hard Refresh (Clear Cache): `Ctrl + F5` or `Ctrl + Shift + R`
- Zoom In / Out / Reset: `Ctrl + Plus` / `Ctrl + Minus` / `Ctrl + 0`

Spreadsheet Modeling Shortcuts (Excel / Google Sheets):

- Edit Active Cell: `F2`
- Toggle Absolute Reference ($): `F4` (cycles A1 → A1 → A$1 → $A1)
- AutoSum Selected Range: `Alt + =`
- Insert Current Date: `Ctrl + ;`
- Fill Down / Fill Right: `Ctrl + D` / `Ctrl + R`
- Select Entire Column: `Ctrl + Space` Entire Row: `Shift + Space`
- Format as Currency: `Ctrl + Shift + 4` (/ £)
- Format as Percentage: `Ctrl + Shift + 5` (%)

OFFICIAL SOLUTIONS, SHORTCUTS & REFERENCE DIRECTORY (CONTINUED)

DIGITAL SKILLS & CYBERSECURITY GLOSSARY

Absolute Cell Reference (A1)
A locked cell coordinate in a spreadsheet formula that does not change when autofilled into adjacent cells.

Bandwidth
The maximum rate of data transfer across a given network path, measured in Megabits per second (Mbps).

Cloud Synchronization
The automated process of mirroring local files to a secure remote cloud server (e.g. OneDrive, Nextcloud).

Cybersecurity Hygiene
Routine practices (e.g. unique passphrases, regular patching, MFA) that maintain security and protect data.

Data Subject Access Request (DSAR)
A formal request under GDPR allowing individuals to obtain a copy of personal data held by an organization.

DSE Assessment
Display Screen Equipment risk assessment mandated by Health and Safety regulations to prevent ergonomic strain.

Encryption (End-to-End)
A communication system where only the communicating users can read the messages, preventing eavesdropping.

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
An authentication method requiring two or more verification factors (password + authenticator app code).

Netiquette
The conventional rules of polite, professional, and respectful behavior in online and email communications.

Phishing
A fraudulent attempt to obtain sensitive information by disguising as a trustworthy entity in electronic communications.

Ransomware
Malicious software designed to block access to a computer system or encrypt files until a sum of money is paid.

URL (Uniform Resource Locator)
The unique address used to identify and locate a specific webpage or file on the World Wide Web.

VPN (Virtual Private Network)
An encrypted connection over the internet from a device to a network, shielding online activity.

DIGITAL SKILLS CURRICULUM INDEX

A

Absolute cell references (A1) 4, 18
Account security & credentials 3, 12, 24
Anti-virus & malware protection 5, 20

B

Backup strategies (3-2-1 rule) 6, 22
Browser safety & SSL padlocks 5, 16
Budgeting spreadsheets 14, 28

C

Cloud collaboration & sharing permissions 7, 26
Conditional formatting rules 15, 29
Cybersecurity essentials 5, 12, 30

D

Data Protection Act & GDPR 8, 32
Data validation dropdowns 14, 28
Digital footprint management 8, 34

E

Email attachments & file size limits 9, 36
Email etiquette & professional register 9, 38
Excel / Sheets formulas 4, 14, 28

F

File folder hierarchy & naming conventions 10, 40
Firewalls & network security 5, 20

I

IF statements & logical formulas 4, 15, 29
Incognito & private browsing 5, 17

M

Mocks 1-4 workplace scenarios 44-59
Multi-factor authentication (MFA) 3, 12, 24

P

Password complexity & managers 3, 12
Phishing & email fraud identification 5, 21
Privacy settings on social platforms 8, 35

S

Shortcuts matrix (Windows & Mac) 60
Solutions for Units 1-10 Drills 61-75
SUM and AVERAGE formulas 4, 14, 28

T

Troubleshooting device connectivity 11, 42
Two-factor authentication (2FA) 3, 12, 24

V

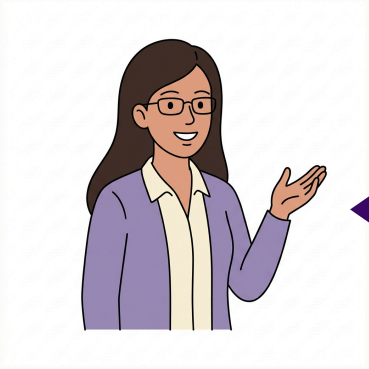
Version control in cloud documents 7, 27
Virtual Private Networks (VPN) 5, 19

NATIONAL STANDARDS MASTERY AUDIT

CP Digital Skills Competency Passport

Statutory Digital Competency Verification

Domain	Level	Assessment Mode	Status	Date
1. Using Devices & Handling Info	Level 1/2	Folder Structure Task	[ ] Competent	
2. Creating & Editing	Level 1/2	Spreadsheet & Chart	[ ] Competent	
3. Communicating	Level 1/2	Formal Email & Calendar	[ ] Competent	
4. Transacting	Level 1/2	E-Commerce & Form Data	[ ] Competent	
5. Being Safe & Responsible	Level 1/2	Security & GDPR Audit	[ ] Competent	



Priya

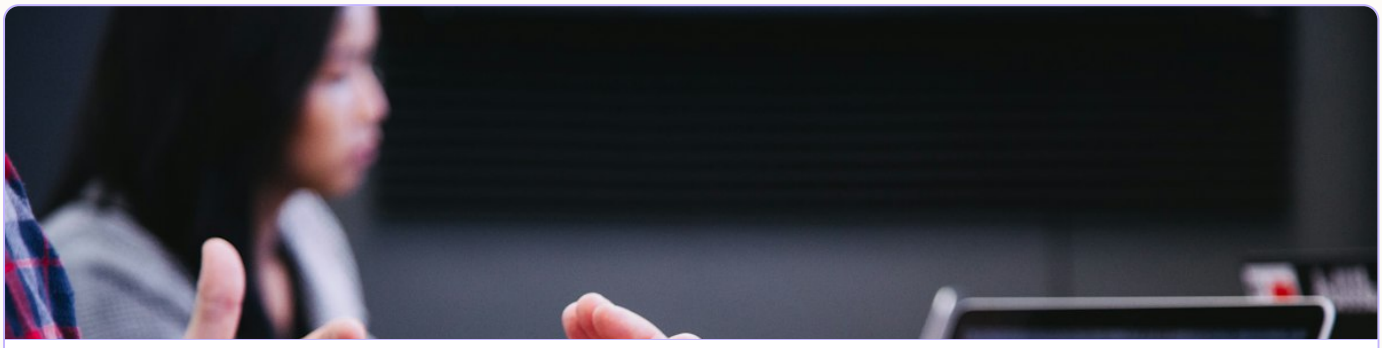
Retain this signed passport in your professional portfolio as evidence of digital literacy for employers and apprenticeship standards.

Personal Professional Development Targets

CERT

NATIONAL CURRICULUM MILESTONE SIGN-OFF

Certificate of Digital Competence



Empowering learners with essential 21st-century digital capabilities.

Master Functional Skills • Certificate of Digital Competence

This certifies that

_____

has completed the Essential Digital Skills National Curriculum and successfully passed all 4 synoptic workplace scenario examinations.

Lead Instructor: Abdul

Date Verified: _____

Practical Exam Score: _____ / 50

Exam Centre: Oxford Health OH

✎ Final Examination Tips & Digital Safety Reminders

Master essential digital skills for work, study, and daily life

Mapped directly to the Department for Education (DfE) National Standards for Essential Digital Skills. Features visual, screenshot-guided instructions for navigating devices, operating cloud systems, communicating professionally, and staying secure online.

INSIDE THIS PUBLICATION

- ✔ **All 5 National Digital Standards:** Using Devices & Handling Information, Creating & Editing, Communicating, Transacting, and Being Safe Online.
- ✔ **Hands-On Workplace Practicality:** File management, spreadsheets, formatting documents, email attachments, and online collaboration tools.
- ✔ **Cybersecurity & Online Safety:** Recognizing phishing emails, password hygiene, two-factor authentication, and data privacy rights.
- ✔ **Digital Transaction Protocols:** Booking appointments, online banking safely, evaluating credible web sources, and public services.
- ✔ **Authentic Practical Assessment Tasks:** Simulated exam scenarios calibrated to Gateway, Pearson, and NCFE EDSQ standards.

Official EDSQ Curriculum Alignment:

Aligned with the statutory National Standards for Essential Digital Skills at Entry Level 3 and Level 1. Ideal for college courses, adult education, and corporate digital literacy programs.

Master Functional Skills Publishing
Approved Assessment Support Materials • Great Britain
Registered Office: Oxford • London • United Kingdom

978-1-912345-86-9